



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:	GENERAL SAFETY LEGISLATION				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

- 1 The Health and Safety at work Act 1974 provides only general guidelines on the way in which work activities are to be carried out.
- 2 Additional, more detailed guidance is provided through the issue of specific regulations which also carry the full force of the law.

Subjects covered by relevant regulations.

Regulations place a legal duty on employers to ensure that employees are not put at undue risk from work activities. In many cases, regulations also put legal duties on employees.

Some aspects of work which is covered by the regulations include:

- General site conditions, including welfare facilities.
- The manual handling of loads
- The safe storage and use of hazardous substances.
- The control of excessive noise levels
- The safe use and storage of LPG and highly flammable liquids
- The reporting of some accidents to the HSE
- The issue and use of personal protective equipment.

You must remember that regulations are a part of health and safety law and must be followed. Speak to your supervisor or safety advisor if you are concerned about safety of anything that you have been instructed to do.

Additional legislation

The Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999:

- Require employers to carry out specific assessments where work is to be carried out by young persons (under the age of 18) due to their inexperience, lack of awareness and lack of appreciation of risk.

Working Time Regulations 1998:

- Limit the number of hours employees can be required to work, averaged out over an agreed period.
- Allow employees to give up their rights under these regulations if an agreement is reached with the employer.

**REMEMBER: IT COULD BE YOUR HEALTH AND SAFETY AT RISK
IF YOU OR YOUR EMPLOYER DO NOT COMPLY WITH REGULATIONS**



Discussion Points

Why is it important not to interfere with items provided for your health and safety?